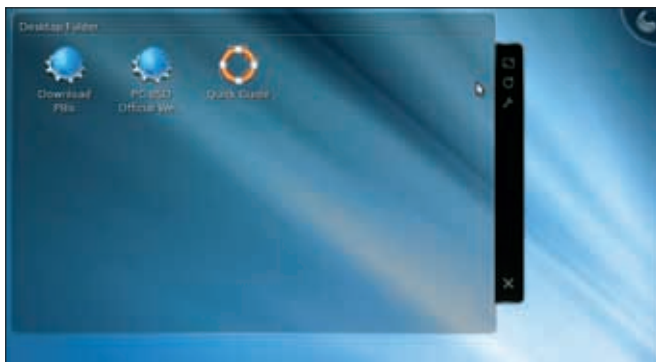


those new to Linux to be comfortable with, but underneath, the functionality for advanced users is not compromised on.

5.7 PC-BSD

BSD is a completely different line of operating system, but one that is based on Unix. BSD stands for Berkeley Software Distribution. PC-BSD is a branch from this movement. BSD was put together at the Berkeley university.

For all practical purposes, it works in the same way as Linux. One of the interesting things with PC-BSD is the inclusion of official drivers for hardware from vendors such as Intel and NVIDIA. So if you have an NVIDIA graphics card, this might be something to keep in mind.



The PC-BSD desktop

PC-BSD is easy to use. It's meant for the casual user and it can be used as an everyday operating system.

The installation is simple but the list of packages provided aren't categorised so you need to know what applications you need. The large installation size means you get more by default as compared to the more compact distributions. The KDE environment and community has applications made for all kinds of purposes. For example, there are plenty of educational programs in PC-BSD. You'll notice that there is a strong emphasis on language, science and maths. There are also simple desktop games in the package. While other distributions focus on giving you the bare necessities, PC-BSD has something for everyone.